

To the editorial board of Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)

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Submission of our article “A Meta-Analysis of the Effects of Group-Based Interventions on Social Reintegration of Marginalized Adults with Mental Illness”

Dear Editors,

Thank you for considering our manuscript. The manuscript presents a systematic review and meta-analysis of the effects of group-based community interventions on the social reintegration and mental health of socially marginalized adults with mental illness. The review synthesizes 49 studies and 349 effect sizes. To our knowledge, this provides the largest and most comprehensive synthesis of this literature to date, both in the breadth of studies included and in its joint focus on social reintegration and mental health outcomes. Specifically, our findings suggest that group-based community interventions are not merely lower-cost alternatives to individual care, but may produce meaningful, multidimensional recovery benefits for marginalized adults with mental illness. We believe these findings are highly relevant for policymakers, researchers, and practitioners seeking to improve care for this vulnerable population. More broadly, we believe the findings speak to a wide PNAS readership by showing the fundamental insight that recovery is not only a clinical process, but also a social one, shaped by human interaction, social connection, and participation in community life.

A distinguishing feature of this review is that the included studies were characterized by unusually strong reporting quality and a high prevalence of preregistration. This generated rare and uniquely rich data, allowing us to apply recently developed, state-of-the-art meta-analytic methods that are seldom feasible in psychological and social science meta-analysis. Together, these features make the review unusually well positioned to provide credible and robust evidence on the effects of group-based community interventions.

The manuscript is approximately 11,5 pages long and contains 7118 words without references and figures. It includes two tables and five figures and follows a peer-reviewed, [preregistered protocol](#) published in *Campbell Systematic Reviews*. All materials and code are openly available on [OSF](#). We have also developed an open-source [R package](#) that implements the partial cluster-bias corrections used in the article. A longer version preprint is available on [PsyArXiv](#).

On behalf of the research team,

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